



Shelf Tagging Guide: "Farm to Aisle" (Canadian-Origin Labels)

Team NavySilver

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Business Overview

Loblaw Companies Limited (L.TO) is a major Canadian retailer offering grocery, pharmacy, healthcare services, health & beauty, apparel, general merchandise, financial services, and wireless products.

Core Problem

Customers want transparent, reliable information about where products are made, especially Canadian-made items, but current packaging often creates confusion rather than clarity.

The World of Loblaw Companies Limited

Loblaw®

C O M P A N I E S L I M I T E D

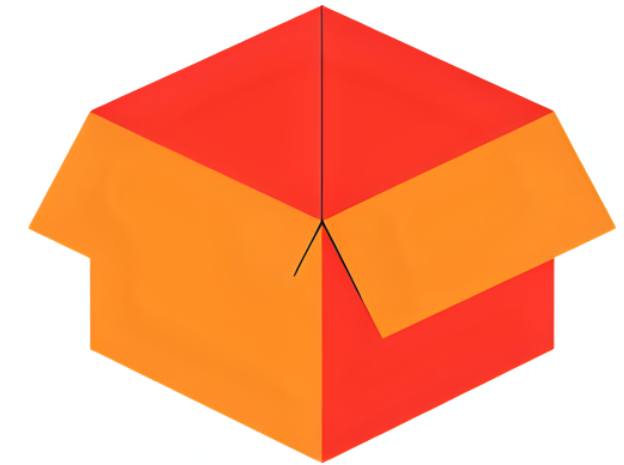




How Might We

How might we design a physical shelf-level display that helps shoppers trust and recognize Canadian-made products?





PRODUCT BACKLOG

1. Shelf-level Tag Design

User Story: As a Canadian shopper, I want to easily see where a product was made so I can support local producers/farmers.

Deliverable: Design and prototype shelf tags that clearly identify “Made in Canada” and “Prepared in Canada” products by color coding tags with bilingual text and recognizable icons.

2. Educational Supporting Signage

User Story: As a Canadian shopper, I want to access a product’s information in-store to learn how and where it was prepared so I can feel confident in its origin.

Deliverable: Create large and small posters that can be placed on shelves, aisles, and walls explaining the meaning of each color.

3. Quick Recognition Test

User Story: As a busy shopper, I want to quickly identify Canadian-made products so I can spend less time deciding between products.

Deliverable: Prototype shelf tags that are highly visible from a distance (~1 meter away from shelf) and conduct a brief user test to ensure shoppers can identify tags in less than 5 seconds.



USER STORIES

As a **Canadian shopper**, I want to easily see where a product was made in Canada so that I can support local producers/farmers.

As a **Canadian shopper**, I want to access a product's information in-store to learn how and where it was prepared so that I feel confident in its origin.

As a **shopper with low vision**, I want tactile and easy to understand shelf cues so that I can easily access origin details and shop comfortably.

As a **busy shopper**, I want to quickly identify Canadian-made products so that I can spend less time deciding between products.

As a **store employee**, I want to clearly tag and display Canadian-made products so that shoppers can easily identify them without needing my help.

As a **store manager**, I want to know which products shoppers interact with most so that I can optimize placement and promotions for Canadian-made items.



ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

User Story	Acceptance Criteria
Canadian shopper — see origin easily	Product origin must be clearly visible on product detail page, origin label must be readable at a glance
Canadian shopper — access info in-store	Tags/QR codes must link to accurate origin & preparation info, Info must load quickly and be easy to understand
Busy shopper — quick identification	Canadian-made products must have a distinct, instantly recognizable visual cue on shelves, Cue must work even among crowded displays
Shopper with low vision — tactile cues	Tactile or high-contrast tags/icons must indicate origin, Braille or raised elements must be easy to locate by touch.
Store employee — clear tagging process	Tagging steps must be simple, intuitive, and prevent user error, Employees must be able to confirm correct placement
Store manager — track engagement	System must track shopper interaction data accurately, Manager dashboard must display top-interacted Canadian-made products.



SPRINT 1 FEEDBACK

WHAT WE LIKED:

- Great user testing on completed deliverables
- Options 1B, 2B, & 2C for **large poster**
- Option 2 for **small poster**
- Option A2, A3, & B3 for **tag design**
- Employee handbook: thoughtful addition to the deliverables

Areas of Improvement:

- Clarity of meaning without needing explanation
- Comprehension through posters, maybe going a step further in educating shoppers
- Conduct brief tests, see which colour/icon means after 3 seconds to a new user
- Clarity of materials in the handbook
- Feedback loop, how do employees know if their work meets standard





SPRINT 2 DELIVERABLES



Large poster



Small poster

User Test Questions

Instruction:

Show the user the educational poster for 3 seconds

Questions:

1. What does the **red colour** mean?
2. What does the **blue colour** mean?
3. What is the **icon** for **Made in Canada**?
4. What is the **icon** for **Prepared in Canada**?
5. Was the poster **clear and easy to understand**? Why or why not?
6. Will you be **looking for these colours and symbols in store**? Why or Why not?

option B3



Prepared in Canada tag

option A3

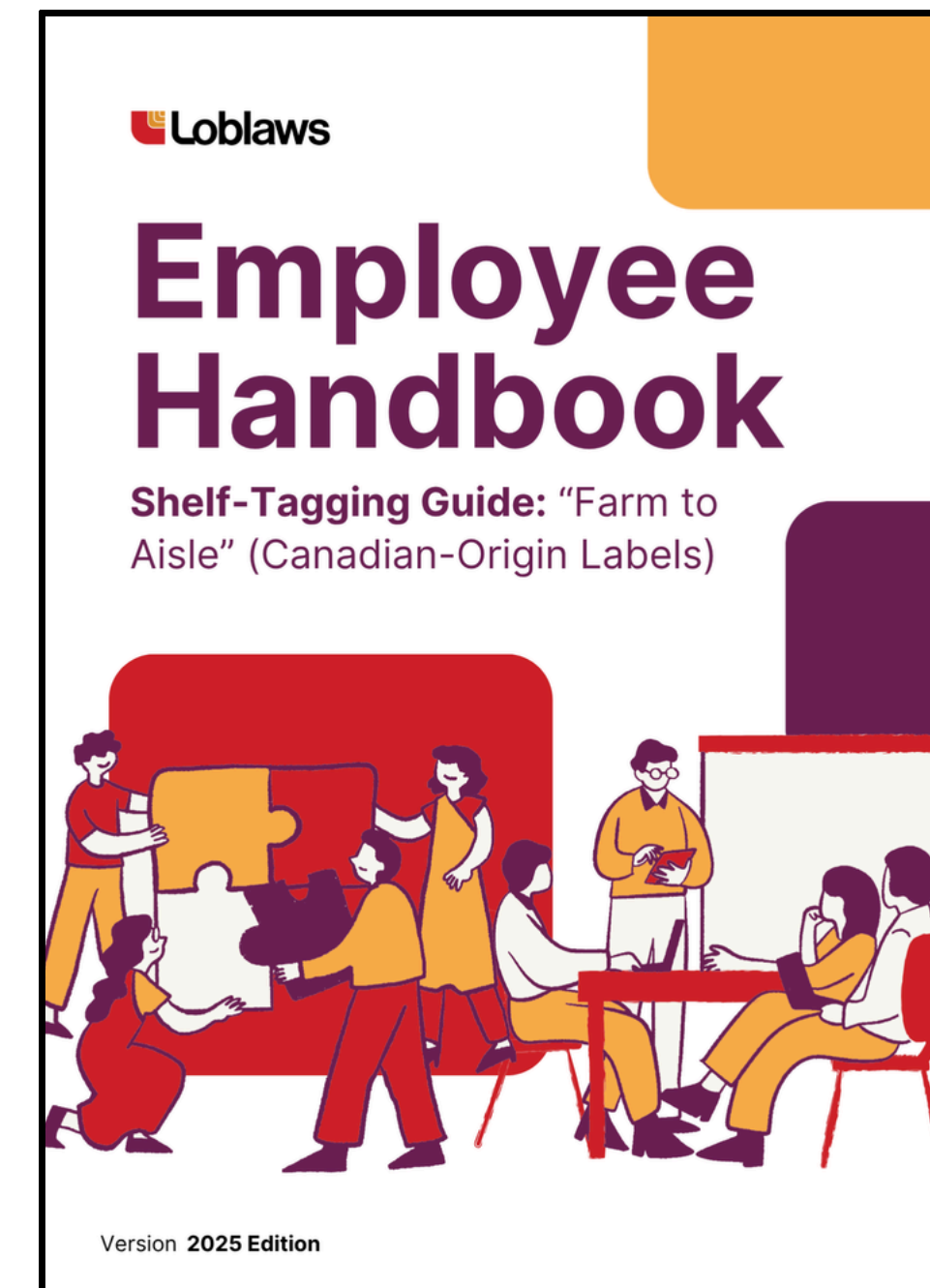


Made in Canada tag



SPRINT REVIEW

- Walk through user stories to show alignment with How Might We + acceptance criteria
- Connect each user story to final design features
- Show iteration: sketches → low-fidelity → final prototype
- Highlight improvements made through feedback
- Demo final increment: shelf-tag system + employee handbook
- Present in a store-like display to simulate real shelf complexity



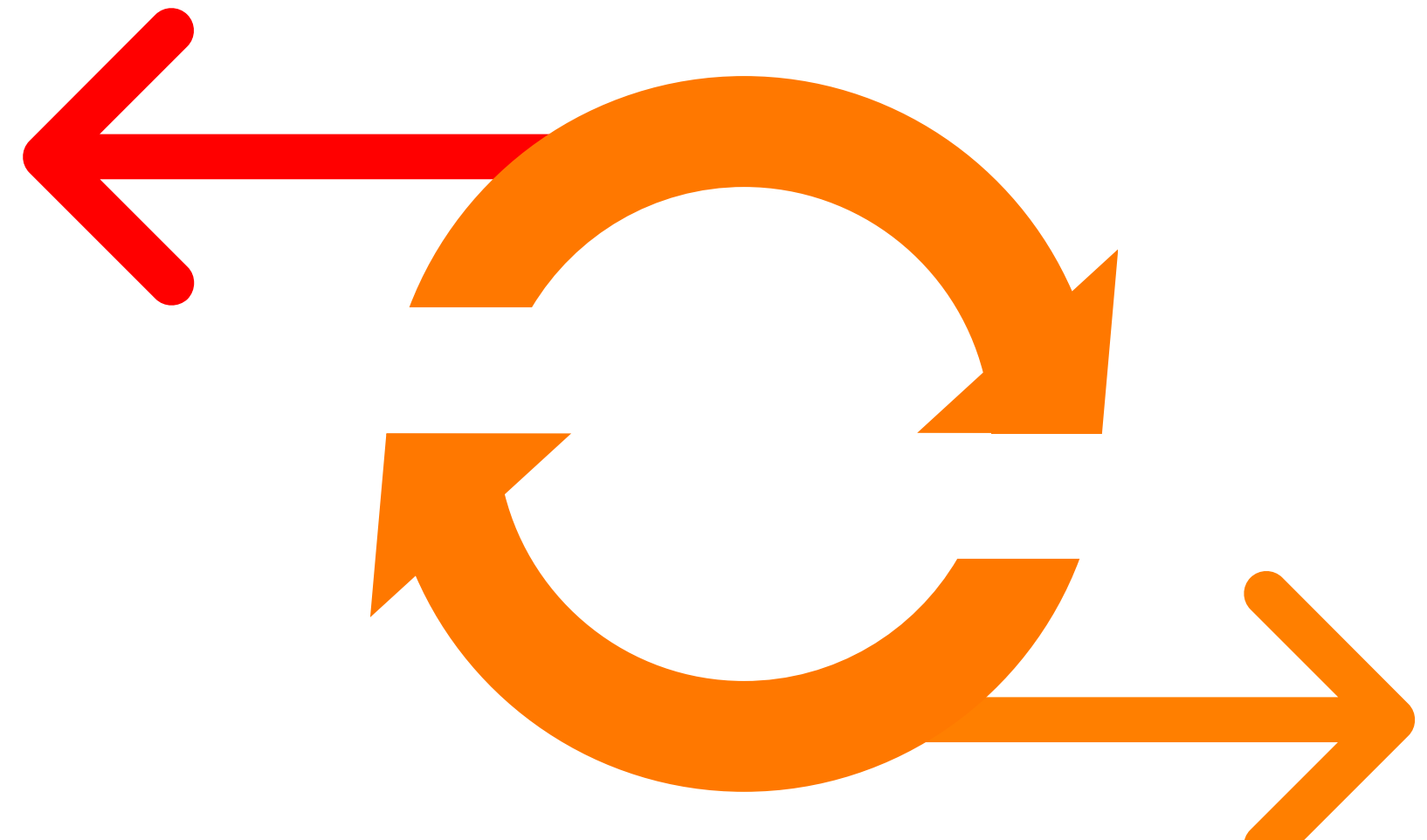


ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA & DEFINITION OF DONE

- Relied on our acceptance criteria and definition of done to give weekly feedback to the development team.
- At times was challenging to provide feedback without revisiting and double-checking the criteria we had set.
- Some product backlog items needed adjustment as situations changed.
- Example: When the team couldn't test prototypes on real store shelves, we revised the backlog to focus on testing printed prototypes in home environments instead.

What to Improve for the Future

- **Revisit** acceptance criteria more often to ensure they stay realistic and aligned with constraints.
- **Build** in flexibility for exploratory testing or unexpected limitations.
- **Provide** clearer guidance on how minor deviations from the definition of done should be handled.





KEY TAKEAWAYS



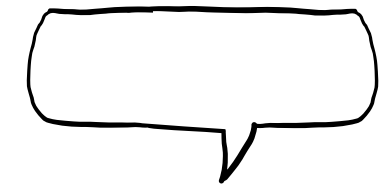
Staying Within Role Boundaries

- Clear separation between Product Owners and Scrum Masters
 - Product Owners: set vision + prioritize backlog
 - Scrum Masters: support team + remove obstacles
- **Impact:** improved efficiency, clarity, and teamwork



Importance of Timing in One-Week Sprints

- With quickly moving sprints, it was important to stay ahead
- Early feedback and preparation prevented last-minute pressure
- **Impact:** Maintained momentum and reduced stress for the Project Managers and the Development Team



Power of Effective Communication

- Communication between the Product Management team and the Development Team was key
- Strong communication led to smooth execution and a confident team
- Kept all members aligned with the team goal
- **Impact:** Ensured alignment and consistent progress